



Arizona Institute for Education & the Economy · NAU

VERSION 26.01 · JUNE 2026 · A FULL REWRITE

Generative AI in K-12 Education

Guidance for Arizona Schools and School Systems

A Call for AI Literacy

A companion to the guidance: a short note on **what's new in 2026**, plus a **prioritized reading route** for each role. Page numbers reference v26.01 — read the full document at azk12.ai.



What's new in 2026 — and why

Version 26.01 is a **full rewrite**, reframed from “A Balanced Perspective” to “**A Call for AI Literacy.**” We revise this guidance as the technology and the research evolve, so it stays current and grounded in what Arizona educators and students are actually experiencing. This edition centers AI literacy and human agency, expands the ethical considerations, and points teaching toward redesign rather than restriction. If you read an earlier version, this one is worth a fresh look; if you're new to it, start with your role's priority pages below — and plan to read the whole thing over time.

Your reading route, by role

These are priorities, not limits — everyone is encouraged to read the whole guidance. Start with Introduction (p. 6) and Understanding GenAI (pp. 8–9), then your role’s priority pages, then the rest.

Superintendent & Cabinet

12–18 min · District vision, public trust, and implementation momentum

● Read first

Introduction & Orientation	p. 6
Understanding GenAI	p. 8–9
The Imperative: AI Literacy & State 48 alignment	p. 22–23
Conclusion & Next Steps (the big picture)	p. 37

● Read next, if time

Implementation Recommendations	p. 32–36
Responsible & Ethical overview + Addressing Considerations	p. 10, 20

“What position statement would help our community understand why we’re moving forward thoughtfully — and how AI literacy connects to the State 48 Graduate Profile?”

Curriculum & Instruction

20–25 min · AI literacy, instructional design, assessment, and academic integrity

● Read first

Understanding GenAI	p. 8–9
Powerful Teaching and Learning	p. 21–29
The Imperative: AI Literacy table	p. 22–23

● Read next, if time

Responsible & Ethical Implementation	p. 10–20
Responsible Classroom Use	p. 26–28

“Which learning tasks should AI support, and which thinking must remain visibly human?”

EdTech & Instructional Coaches

22–30 min · Practical adoption, teacher support, approved tools, and PD

● Read first

Understanding GenAI p. 8–9

Powerful Teaching and Learning p. 21–29

Implementation Recommendations p. 32–36

● Read next, if time

Additional Resources: AI literacy & PD p. 38

School & Administrative Use p. 30–31

“What reusable models, examples, and guardrails help educators move from fear or novelty to purposeful use?”

IT, Cybersecurity & Data Privacy

15–22 min · Data protection, cybersecurity, vendor review, and agentic risk

● Read first

Understanding GenAI (esp. agentic AI) p. 8–9

Data and Information Privacy p. 14–15

Cybersecurity p. 19

Addressing Ethical Considerations p. 20

● Read next, if time

School & Administrative Use risks p. 30–31

Implementation: approved tools & policy p. 34–36

“Where do permissions, integrations, and data exposure create the highest risk?”

Principal & Site Administrator

15–20 min · School norms, staff clarity, classroom use, and family trust

● Read first

Introduction & Orientation	p. 6
Understanding GenAI	p. 8–9
Responsible Classroom Use	p. 26–28
School and Administrative Use	p. 30–31

● Read next, if time

Responsible & Ethical Implementation	p. 10–20
Implementation: 3ssentials & guidelines	p. 34–36

“What common expectations would reduce confusion for teachers, students, and families?”

Operations, HR & Finance

10–15 min · Workflow enhancement, multilingual communication, and human oversight

● Read first

Understanding GenAI	p. 8–9
School and Administrative Use	p. 30–31
Data and Information Privacy	p. 14–15

● Read next, if time

Cybersecurity	p. 19
Implementation Recommendations	p. 32–36

“Which workflow has clear rules, repeated steps, and low-risk data where AI could safely help?”

Teachers

15–22 min · Instructional practice, student agency, and responsible use

● Read first

Teacher Use Cases	p. 24
Student Use Cases	p. 25
Responsible Classroom Use	p. 26–28
The Redesign: AI Inspiration	p. 29

● Read next, if time

Understanding GenAI	p. 8–9
Responsible & Ethical overview	p. 10

“How can AI be a coach or thought partner without becoming an assignment’s easy button?”



An unofficial reading guide to Arizona's 2026 GenAI guidance (v26.01), 41 pages. Page numbers reference that edition; always read the live document at azk12.ai. Produced by the Arizona Institute for Education & the Economy companion project · June 2026.